

Cybercrime Case Study

Title

Phishing Scam: A Common Cybercrime Case

Introduction

Cybercrime refers to criminal activities carried out using digital devices, computer systems, or the internet. One of the most common and dangerous cybercrimes is **phishing****.**

Phishing is a method used by cybercriminals to trick people into sharing confidential information such as passwords, banking details, OTPs, or account credentials.

Case Description

A student received an email that appeared to be from a bank. The message claimed that the student's bank account would be blocked unless account details were updated immediately.

The email contained a link that looked similar to the official bank website. Believing the message to be genuine, the student clicked on the link and entered login credentials along with OTP details.

Within a short time, money was withdrawn from the student's bank account without authorization.

What Went Wrong?

The following mistakes led to the cyber fraud:

- The student trusted the email without verifying the sender**
- The website link was not checked carefully**
- Sensitive banking details were entered on a fake website**
- OTP was shared indirectly through the fraudulent page**

Warning Signs in the Scam

Some clear warning signs were present in the message:

- The email created panic and urgency**
- The sender's email address was suspicious**
- The website was not the official banking domain**
- The message asked for confidential information**

Impact of the Cybercrime

The phishing attack caused multiple problems:

- Financial loss**
- Stress and confusion**
- Compromise of personal account security**
- Risk of future misuse of information**

Lessons Learned

This case shows that users must be very careful while dealing with online messages and links.

Important lessons include:

- Never share OTP, passwords, or PINs**
- Always verify the sender before trusting any email**
- Avoid clicking on unknown or suspicious links**
- Use only official apps or verified websites**
- Stay calm and avoid reacting to panic-based messages**

Conclusion

Phishing scams are very common and can affect anyone, especially students who frequently use online platforms and digital

communication. Awareness, caution, and good cyber habits are essential to stay protected from such cybercrimes.